# Deserts

Deserts are dry regions that usually receive less than 250 millimetres of rain in a year. The Sahara in North Africa is the largest hot desert, covering an area nearly the size of the United States. Desert days can be scorching hot, while nights can turn surprisingly cold because the dry air holds little heat. Camels can go for many days without drinking, and cactus plants store moisture inside their thick stems. Antarctica is also counted as a desert, a cold one, because so little snow or rain falls there.